

SENATE No. 162

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Liz Miranda

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act authorizing the Executive Office of Health and Human Services to establish a Direct Care Worker Medication Administration Program Registry.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Liz Miranda

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

Second Suffolk

SENATE No. 162

By Ms. Miranda, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 162) of Liz Miranda for legislation to authorize the Executive Office of Health and Human Services to establish a Direct Care Worker Medication Administration Program Registry. Children, Families and Persons with Disabilities.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act authorizing the Executive Office of Health and Human Services to establish a Direct Care Worker Medication Administration Program Registry.

Whereas, The deferred operation of this act would tend to defeat its purpose, which is to establish forthwith a Direct care worker registry, therefore it is hereby declared to be an emergency law, necessary for the immediate preservation of the public convenience. , therefore it is hereby declared to be an emergency law, necessary for the immediate preservation of the public convenience.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 13C of Chapter 118E General Laws is hereby amended by
2 inserting after the second paragraph the following section Subsections (a) and (b):-

3 Subsection Section (a) As used in this section, the following terms shall have the
4 following meanings unless the context clearly requires otherwise:

5 “Employee organization”, a labor union or other organization, agency or employee
6 representation committee, association, group or plan in which employees participate and which

exists in whole or in part to deal with employers concerning matters incidental to employment relationships.

“Direct care worker”, a person employed by an agency whose rates are set by chapter 257 of the laws of 2008, to provide direct care and/or medication administration.

“Direct care worker agency”, an entity employing direct care workers to provide services whose rates are set by chapter 257 of the law of 2008.

Subsection (b) The Executive Office of health and Human services shall establish and maintain a Direct care worker Medication Administration Program registry of direct care workers employed by a direct care worker agency.

A direct care worker agency shall report to the Executive office of health and human services the required direct care worker registry information for each direct care worker it employs or contracts for the services of on a paid, unpaid, temporary or permanent basis who is not exempt from the reporting requirement. Any exemptions from reporting shall be established in regulations promulgated by the Executive office of health and human services; provided, however, that the regulations shall include, but not be limited to, exemptions for victims of domestic violence, rape, sexual assault or stalking.

The executive office shall collect the following reported information concerning each direct care worker: (i) the worker’s full name; (ii) their assigned unique identification number; (iii) their gender; (iv) their home address; (v) their mailing address; (vi) the full legal name of any direct care worker agency employing the direct care worker; (vii) the worker’s job title; and (viii) a list of Direct care trainings or certifications completed by the direct care worker. (ix) the status of their Medication Administration Program certification, pass, fail or pending.

Reported information for each employed direct care worker shall be submitted and regularly updated every quarter by each direct care worker agency subject to this section. The registry shall be updated by the Executive office of health and human services at least quarterly. A direct care worker agency shall collect and maintain the required information and submit updated information in a timely manner as determined by the department. A direct care worker shall not be responsible for any costs related to the registry.

The Executive office of health and human services shall only make a direct care worker's full name, identification number, name of any direct care worker agency employing the direct care worker and a list of direct care trainings or certifications completed by the direct care worker available to the public unless such information is exempt from disclosure by the department. Upon request from an employee organization, or direct care worker agency, the department shall provide all reported information to such entities.

The Executive office of health and human services shall promulgate rules and regulations and shall provide such forms and notifications as may be necessary to implement this section; provided, however, that the executive office of health and human services shall minimize any duplicate reporting that may be required of a direct care agency.

Subsection C. This act shall take effect within 90 days of its passage.